Evasion Without Answers: An Empirical Study of the *Shadow* Keyword's Win-Rate Premium in a Custom *Magic: The Gathering* Cube

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Abstract

We investigate whether the *Shadow* keyword ability – an evasion mechanic under which affected creatures can be blocked only by other Shadow creatures – produces a disproportionate competitive advantage in a custom, 360-card "old-border" retro cube for *Magic: The Gathering*. Combining automated draft simulation (CubeCobra) with automated head-to-head match simulation (the open-source *Forge* game engine), we generated 100 eight-player drafts and played out the resulting 2,800 round-robin matches. An initial diagnosis on a 10-draft pilot sample suggested that Shadow's apparent strength might be an artifact of the game engine's own under-blocking behavior (mean legal-blocking rate ≈ 17–21%) rather than a property of the mechanic itself. Reconstructing true legal blocking opportunities from raw match logs and correlating them against Shadow-deck win rate on the full 100-draft corpus overturns this hypothesis: the correlation collapses from $r = +0.689$ ($n = 10$) to $r \approx +0.07$–0.10 ($n = 91$–180, all $p > 0.27$) and is never negative, which is the opposite of the signature a blocking-artifact explanation would predict. Decks whose winning seat carries at least one Shadow card win 57% of the 100 drafts studied. Cross-tabulating win rate by color count and Shadow presence isolates two additive, statistically independent effects: mono-color consistency contributes roughly +5 to +7 percentage points, while Shadow contributes an additional +21 to +22 points regardless of color count ($p < 10^{-15}$ for all four pairwise comparisons). We conclude that Shadow's advantage in this specific cube's card pool is intrinsic to the mechanic rather than an artifact of simulated-opponent blocking behavior, while explicitly noting the observational (non-causal) nature of the evidence and the small amount of corroborating human playtest data currently available.

1 Introduction

Cube design – the construction of a large, singleton card pool intended for repeated limited-format drafting – is typically iterated on through subjective playtesting and community consensus rather than controlled measurement. Claims that a given card or mechanic is "too strong" are common in cube design communities but are rarely backed by match-level data, in part because generating enough games to say anything statistically meaningful about a specific card is prohibitively time-consuming for human playtesters.

This paper documents an attempt to close that gap for one specific, falsifiable question that arose during the iterative construction of a 360-card retro-styled cube (pre-2003 card frame, or officially reprinted in that frame by more recent products): *does the Shadow keyword confer a win-rate advantage large enough to warrant a design change, and if so, is that advantage a property of the mechanic itself or an artifact of the automated opponent used to generate match data?*

Shadow is a static evasion ability first introduced in *Tempest* (1997): a creature with Shadow "can block or be blocked by only creatures with shadow." Unlike flying or other partial-evasion keywords, a deck with zero Shadow creatures of its own has *no legal way to block* a Shadow attacker under any circumstance, independent of board state. This unconditional character makes Shadow a natural candidate for producing an inflated win rate specifically against an AI opponent that under-utilizes blocking in general, since a general blocking weakness would be invisible against Shadow (there is nothing to fail to do) while being fully exposed against ordinary evasion-free creatures. Distinguishing "Shadow is intrinsically strong" from "the simulator cannot punish Shadow's downside-free evasion" is therefore the central methodological problem this paper addresses.

2 The Cube and Simulation Pipeline

2.1 Card pool

The cube under study contains 360 non-land cards drafted from Magic sets released through late 2003, supplemented by mechanically newer cards later reprinted in an official "retro" or "old-border" card frame (e.g. *Time Spiral Remastered*, *Ravnica Remastered*, *Modern Horizons 2/3*, *Innistrad Remastered*, *The Brothers' War: Retro Frame Artifacts*), so that every physical card in the eventual paper cube shares a consistent pre-2003 visual frame regardless of the card's original mechanical release date. The cube's intended paper-draft format allocates a 20-card mana-fixing pool (ten historical pain lands and their corresponding ten guildgates) to a separate secondary land-draft phase, distinct from the 360-card main pool. *The CubeCobra-simulated corpus analyzed in this paper does not implement this separation*: CubeCobra's bot-drafting simulator has no mechanism for a secondary land sub-draft, so all 380 cards – fixing lands included – were drafted as ordinary pack contents in a single undifferentiated pool. This is a genuine divergence between the simulated environment analyzed here and the cube's intended real-world paper format, discussed further in §4.2. The cube supports both traditional one-versus-one and free-for-all (FFA) multiplayer play; it was not designed with either format as an explicit priority, and its playtesting history to date happens to have started with FFA sessions for circumstantial rather than design reasons. The 8-player, one-versus-one round-robin format used to generate the simulation data analyzed here is consequently a legitimate target format in its own right, not merely a simulation-driven compromise against an FFA-first design – though it is also, separately, the more practical format to simulate at scale, since Forge does not currently support multiplayer free-for-all simulation.

2.2 Draft simulation

Draft pools were generated using CubeCobra's bot-drafting simulator, which uses a learned per-card "Elo" rating and pack-signal heuristics to approximate human drafting behavior across an 8-seat pod. One hundred independent 8-player drafts were generated, yielding 800 constructed decks.

2.3 Match simulation

Each of the 800 decks was exported to Forge's native `.dck` format. Forge (an open-source, rules-complete *Magic: The Gathering* engine with a scriptable AI opponent) was used to play a full round-robin within each 8-player draft pod ($\binom{8}{2} = 28$ single-game matches per draft, 2,800 matches total), invoked via Forge's headless `sim` command-line mode. Every match was logged at full verbosity (attack/block declarations, zone changes, stack resolutions, life totals).

2.4 Win-detection correction

An initial analysis pipeline determined match winners from three redundant log line patterns (Match Winner -, Game Outcome: ... has won, and ... has won!). Manual log inspection revealed that AI-vs-AI matches that reach Forge's per-game time limit (120,000 ms) can emit two contradictory Game Outcome: ... has won lines in immediate succession for a single game. Because the original pipeline credited whichever line it encountered first, at least one match result was misattributed to the losing seat rather than the winner. This was corrected by switching to the single, unambiguous Match Result: <seat$_1$>: <score$_1$ > <seat$_2$>: <score $_2$> summary line, which appears exactly once per match. Across the full 100-draft corpus, 6 anomalous matches across 5 drafts were identified and correctly resolved this way (4 AI-timeout cases and one genuine simultaneous double-loss requiring a Forge-adjudicated replay game).

2.5 Legal blocking-rate reconstruction

A naïve count of didn't block log lines over-states the AI's blocking passivity, because it does not distinguish (a) turns on which the defending player controlled no creature at all, and (b) attacks that were legally unblockable given the defender's board (Shadow attackers facing a non-Shadow board; flying attackers facing a board with no flying or reach creature) from (c) genuine refusals to block a creature the defender could legally have blocked. We reconstructed per-player board state directly from the log by tracking creature-resolution and graveyard/exile zone-change events (card ownership is unambiguous in a singleton card pool) and cross-referenced attacker keywords against Forge's own card database (rather than a hand-curated list) to classify every non-block decision into one of these three categories. The *legal blocking rate* is then defined as

$$\text{block\_rate} = \frac{\text{real\_block}}{\text{real\_block} + \text{real\_nonblock}},$$

i.e. blocks divided by blocks plus *genuine* refusals, excluding both empty-board turns and legally-unblockable attacks from the denominator.

3 Results

3.1 Blocking rate

Across the 100 drafts, the legal blocking rate averages 23.71% (SD = 4.37, range 13.36–34.29%). This is markedly higher than a naïve count would suggest (which, on early pilot data, understated the rate by roughly half), but confirms that Forge's AI opponent under-utilizes blocking relative to a competent human player in absolute terms.

3.2 Shadow dominance frequency

In 57 of the 100 drafts, the tournament-winning deck (highest match record in its 8-player pod) carries at least one Shadow creature. Figure 1 shows the distribution of final standings across all 180 (draft, seat) pairs in which a deck carries at least one Shadow card: the modal outcome for a Shadow-carrying deck is an outright win, with a roughly monotonic decline in frequency at lower standings.

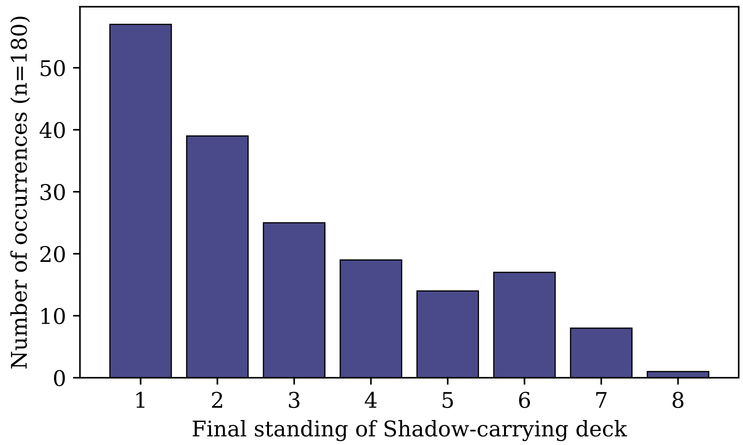

Figure 1: Final standing distribution for the 180 (draft, seat) pairs in which the seat's deck contains at least one Shadow card, across 100 eight-player drafts.

3.3 Blocking rate versus Shadow performance

An initial 3-draft pilot, followed by a 10-draft extension, found a strongly positive correlation ($r = +0.689$) between a draft's legal blocking rate and the win rate of its most Shadow-concentrated deck – the *opposite* sign to what an under-blocking-artifact explanation predicts (that hypothesis predicts $r < 0$: less blocking should mechanically favor an unblockable attacker). Recomputing the same three cuts of the data on the full 100-draft corpus (Table 1) collapses the correlation toward zero under every definition of "the Shadow deck."

Table 1: Pearson correlation between per-draft legal blocking rate and Shadow-deck win rate, for three ways of defining the relevant deck(s), on the 10-draft pilot versus the full 100-draft corpus.

Definition of "Shadow deck"	n (100-draft)	r (10-draft pilot)	r, p (100-draft)
Single most Shadow-concentrated deck per draft	99	+0.689	+0.073, $p = 0.47$
All seats carrying ≥ 1 Shadow card (splash included)	180	+0.152	+0.081, $p = 0.28$
Seats with a concentrated package (≥ 2 distinct Shadow cards)	91	+0.384	+0.099, $p = 0.35$

None of the three 100-draft correlations is statistically distinguishable from zero. Two individual drafts illustrate the pattern directly: *draft_54* has the highest legal blocking rate in the entire corpus (34.29%) and is nonetheless won by a Shadow-carrying deck; *draft_100* has the lowest blocking rate in the corpus (13.36%) and is won by a deck with zero Shadow cards. If the AI's general under-blocking were the primary driver of Shadow's success, both cases should run in the opposite direction.

3.4 Color count, Shadow, and win rate

Table 2 pools match results across all 800 decks by color count (mono- versus multi-color, decks whose archetype label did not resolve to an identifiable color count are reported separately and excluded from the comparisons below) crossed with the presence or absence of at least one Shadow card in the deck's registered card list.

Table 2: Pooled match win rate by color count and Shadow presence (2-proportion z-test against the same color-count group without Shadow).

Group	Decks	W/M	Win rate	vs. no-Shadow, same color count
Mono-color, without Shadow	250	842/1750	48.11%	– (baseline)
Mono-color, with Shadow	116	569/812	70.07%	$z = 10.40$, $p = 2.6 \times 10^{-25}$
Multi-color, without Shadow	345	1032/2415	42.73%	– (baseline)
Multi-color, with Shadow	64	284/448	63.39%	$z = 8.06$, $p = 7.7 \times 10^{-16}$

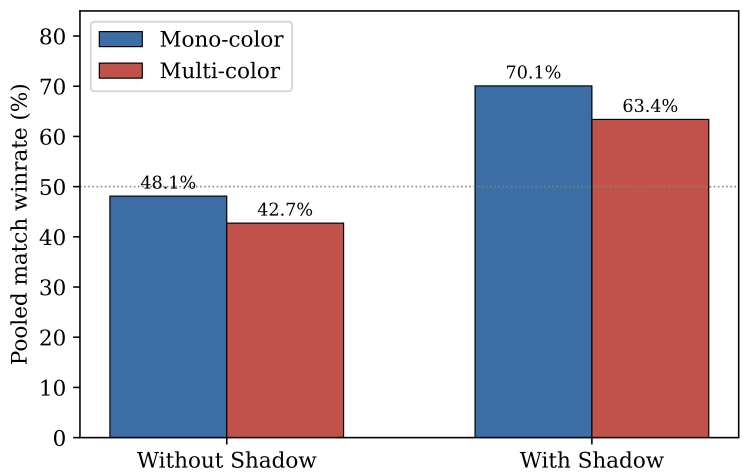

Figure 2: Pooled win rate by color count and Shadow presence (n = 2,562 mono-color and n = 2,863 multi-color matches in total). Error bars are omitted for legibility; all four pairwise gaps in Table 2 and Table 3 are significant at $p < 0.05$.

Table 3 decomposes the same four cells into two candidate effects: a mono-color consistency premium (comparing mono to multi-color *within* the same Shadow status) and a Shadow premium (comparing with- to without-Shadow *within* the same color-count class).

Both the mono-color premium and the Shadow premium are individually significant and of comparable magnitude regardless of the level of the other factor, indicating the two effects are close to independent. A purely additive model ($\text{mono\_noShadow} + \Delta_{\text{Shadow}} + \Delta_{\text{mono}}$) over-predicts the mono-with-Shadow cell by roughly 4 percentage points (74.15% predicted vs. 70.07% observed), consistent with mild ceiling compression as combined win rate approaches its upper bound rather than a qualitatively different interaction. In all four comparisons, the Shadow effect ($\approx +21$ points) is three to four times larger in magnitude than the color-count effect ($\approx +5$–7 points).

Table 3: Decomposition into a mono-color effect and a Shadow effect.

Comparison	Δ (points)	significance
Mono − Multi, without Shadow ("mono premium", baseline)	+5.38	$p = 5.7 \times 10^{-4}$
Mono − Multi, with Shadow ("mono premium", with Shadow)	+6.68	$p = 1.5 \times 10^{-2}$
With − without Shadow, mono-color ("Shadow premium", mono)	+21.96	$p = 2.6 \times 10^{-25}$
With − without Shadow, multi-color ("Shadow premium", multi)	+20.66	$p = 7.7 \times 10^{-16}$

4 Discussion

4.1 Interpretation

The central finding is a dissociation between two candidate explanations for Shadow's apparent strength that were, prior to this analysis, difficult to distinguish from qualitative play testing alone. An under-blocking-artifact account predicts that Shadow's advantage should shrink as the simulated opponent's legal blocking rate rises; the data show no such relationship at $n = 100$, and the $n = 10$ correlation that initially suggested one is better explained as small-sample noise given how completely it collapses on replication. The color-count crosstab further shows that Shadow's win-rate premium is not a proxy for the previously-hypothesized mana-consistency advantage of mono-color decks: both effects are present, of different magnitude, and largely additive.

4.2 Limitations

The evidence remains observational. Shadow-carrying decks are not randomly assigned; they are the product of a drafting process in which a human or bot drafter chose to commit to the archetype, and such decks may differ from non-Shadow decks along dimensions other than the presence of Shadow cards themselves (e.g. overall card quality of the surrounding shell, curve, or removal density) that were not controlled for here. The finding that Shadow's premium is stable across the mono/multi-color split partially addresses this concern by ruling out one specific confound, but does not rule out others.

Separately, Forge's AI opponent's general under-blocking behavior ($\bar{x} = 23.71\%$ legal blocking rate) remains a genuine simulation-fidelity concern independent of the Shadow question: a rate this low likely inflates the absolute win rate of *any* aggressive or evasive strategy relative to human play, even where (as shown here) it does not differentially explain Shadow's specific advantage over other mechanics. The single available human playtest data point for this cube (a two-player match between a Boros aggro deck and a Golgari midrange deck, won 2–1 by the aggro deck) is consistent with, but far too small a sample to independently confirm, the direction of this general concern.

Finally, all data reported here come from 1-versus-1 round-robin play. The cube supports both 1v1 and free-for-all (FFA) multiplayer without a strict design preference for either (§2.1), so this is not a mismatch against some other "intended" format − but several mechanics evaluated qualitatively during this project's design process (symmetric life-total taxes, edict effects, board-wide damage sources) are known to behave differently between 1v1 and FFA regardless, and we make no claim that Shadow's measured premium transfers unchanged to FFA play specifically.

A related and more consequential divergence concerns mana fixing, and it bears specifically on the mono-color premium reported in §3.4 rather than on the Shadow finding. Because the simulated corpus drafted all 20 fixing lands as ordinary pack contents (§2.1) rather than through the cube's intended separate land draft, a multi-color deck in this corpus had to spend some of its limited picks on fixing lands that a mono-color deck could skip entirely in favor of an additional spell. This creates a plausible drafting-mechanism confound distinct from any genuine in-game mana-consistency advantage: part of the measured +5–7 point mono-color premium (Table 3) could reflect multi-color decks being systematically diluted with lower-impact picks by the drafting process itself, rather than (or in addition to) mono-color decks benefiting from more reliable mana during play.

We tested this directly on the existing corpus rather than leaving it as an open question. Restricting to the 403 strictly two-color decks (a subset of the 409-deck bi/tri-color group in Table 2, which also includes 6 three-color decks), we counted how many of the cube's 20 dedicated fixing lands each deck's registered card list actually contained and tested this count against win rate (Table 4).

Table 4: Two-color decks only: pooled win rate by number of dedicated fixing lands drafted (0 of 20, 1–2, or 3 or more). Pearson correlation across all 403 decks: $r = -0.003$, $p = 0.96$.

Fixing lands in deck	Decks	Matches (W/M)	Win rate
0	30	90/210	42.86%
1–2	357	1170/2499	46.82%
3+	16	42/112	37.50%

We find no relationship between fixing-land count and win rate: the correlation is indistinguishable from zero, and win rate does not decline monotonically with more fixing lands drafted (the 1–2 tier outperforms the 0 tier, the opposite of what the opportunity-cost hypothesis predicts). The 3+ tier's lower rate is based on only 16 decks and should not be over-interpreted. This provides no support for the pick-opportunity-cost explanation of the mono-color premium; a genuine in-game mana-consistency advantage, or some other unmeasured factor, remains the more likely explanation, though we did not test those alternatives directly. Critically, this confound (supported or not) cannot explain the Shadow finding itself: the Shadow premium in Table 3 is measured *within* each color-count stratum (mono-with- vs. mono-without-Shadow; multi-with- vs. multi-without-Shadow), so any general pick-opportunity-cost effect from mixed land drafting would apply symmetrically to both terms of each comparison and cancel out of the estimated Shadow effect regardless. Whether the intended separate land draft remains worth its added setup complexity for a human table – independent of this statistical question – is a design decision this paper does not attempt to settle.

4.3 Design implications

Taken together, the results support treating Shadow's competitive advantage in this cube as a property of the mechanic and card pool rather than an artifact of the specific automated opponent used to generate the data, and therefore as a legitimate candidate for a deliberate design intervention (reducing Shadow card density, adding dedicated answers, or removing the sub-theme) rather than something to be dismissed as a simulation quirk.

5 Conclusion

Across 100 automated drafts and 2,800 simulated matches, a Shadow-carrying deck wins its draft pod 57% of the time, and carrying at least one Shadow card is associated with a win-rate premium of roughly 21 points, independent of the deck's color count and essentially uncorrelated with the simulated opponent's legal blocking rate ($|r| < 0.10$ under three different data cuts, none significant). An initial small-sample analysis had suggested the opposite conclusion was plausible; replicating the analysis at ten times the sample size was sufficient to overturn it. We take this as a case study in why cube balance claims – like most claims resting on a handful of observed games – benefit from exactly this kind of scale before being acted on.

Acknowledgments

This analysis was conducted as part of an iterative, multi-assistant cube design process; log-parsing and simulation-pipeline code was developed and progressively corrected across sessions with several large language model assistants, including review and cross-checking of intermediate results between them. All numerical results in this paper were independently recomputed from the raw `shadow_seats_detail.csv`, `shadow_vs_blocking.csv`, and `mono_vs_shadow.csv` export files rather than taken from any single assistant's prior summary.

A Full card pool

The 360-card draftable pool at the time the 100-draft corpus analyzed in this paper was generated, listed by color/type category. One card added to the pool after data collection (*Doubtless One*, White) is included below for completeness but does not appear in the per-card statistics reported in §3–4, since it was never drafted into any of the 100 pools. The cube's intended paper format allocates a further 20-card pool (Table A) to a separate secondary land draft; as noted in §4.2, the simulated corpus analyzed in this paper does not implement that separation and drafted these 20 cards alongside the 360-card main pool instead.

White (53)

- Ajani's Pridemate
- Akroma's Vengeance
- Armageddon
- Arrest
- Aura of Silence
- Banishing Light
- Beloved Chaplain
- Benevolent Bodyguard
- Blinding Angel
- Condemn
- Decree of Justice
- Disenchant
- Doubtless One
- Enlightened Tutor
- Eternal Dragon
- Exile
- Gather the Townsfolk
- Glorious Anthem
- Glory
- Humble
- Intrepid Hero
- Knight of Dawn
- Land Tax
- Longbow Archer
- Lunarch Veteran
- Master Decoy
- Mentor of the Meek
- Mobilization
- Mother of Runes
- Order of Leitbur
- Order of the White Shield
- Orim's Prayer
- Pacifism
- Paladin en-Vec
- Path to Exile
- Savannah Lions
- Seal of Cleansing
- Serra Angel
- Shelter
- Soltari Champion
- Soltari Monk
- Soltari Trooper
- Soul Warden
- Stonehorn Dignitary
- Story Circle
- Swords to Plowshares
- Thraben Inspector
- True Believer
- Unquestioned Authority
- Weathered Wayfarer
- Whipcorder
- White Knight
- Wrath of God

Blue (51)

- Air Elemental
- Aquamoeba
- Boomerang
- Braingeyser
- Brainstorm
- Capsize
- Careful Study
- Circular Logic
- Clone
- Cloud of Faeries
- Cloudskate
- Counterspell
- Daze
- Deep Analysis
- Delver of Secrets
- Equilibrium
- Fact or Fiction
- Fade Away
- Forbid
- Force Spike
- Force of Will
- Frantic Search
- Great Whale
- Gush
- Impulse
- Man-o'-War
- Mana Breach
- Mana Leak
- Memory Lapse
- Merfolk Looter
- Mulldrifter
- Ninja of the Deep Hours
- Opposition
- Opt
- Peregrine Drake
- Ponder
- Propaganda
- Psionic Blast
- Repulse
- Rhystic Study
- Serendib Efreet
- Snap
- Snapcaster Mage
- Stormscape Familiar
- Stroke of Genius
- Thieving Magpie
- Thing in the Ice
- Time Warp
- Wall of Tears
- Wash Out
- Wonder

Black (57)

- Accursed Marauder
- Ashen Ghoul
- Black Knight
- Blood Artist
- Bone Shredder
- Cabal Archon
- Carnophage
- Carrion Feeder
- Chainer's Edict
- Coffin Purge
- Crypt Rats
- Dark Confidant
- Dark Ritual
- Darkness
- Dauthi Horror
- Dauthi Slayer
- Diabolic Edict
- Dismember
- Duress
- Exhume
- Faceless Butcher
- Fallen Angel
- Feed the Swarm
- Festering Goblin
- Gisa's Bidding
- Graveborn Muse
- Gravedigger
- Gray Merchant of Asphodel
- Gurmag Angler
- Hymn to Tourach
- Hypnotic Specter
- Innocent Blood
- Knight of Stromgald
- Lord of the Undead
- Mesmeric Fiend
- Mindslicer
- Nantuko Shade
- Necropotence
- Order of the Ebon Hand
- Phyrexian Arena
- Phyrexian Plaguelord
- Phyrexian Rager
- Phyrexian Reclamation
- Profane Tutor
- Putrid Imp
- Ravenous Rats
- Rotlung Reanimator
- Shriekmaw
- Snuff Out
- Terror
- Tragic Slip
- Twisted Abomination
- Unearth
- Village Rites
- Withered Wretch
- Zombie Infestation
- Zulaport Cutthroat

Red (50)

- Abrade
- Anger
- Anger of the Gods
- Arc Lightning
- Avalanche Riders
- Ball Lightning
- Blasphemous Act
- Chaos Warp
- Earthquake
- Faithless Looting
- Fervor
- Fiery Temper
- Fireblast
- Firebolt
- Flametongue Kavu
- Fling
- Goblin Bombardment
- Goblin Grenade
- Goblin King
- Goblin Lackey
- Goblin Matron
- Goblin Patrol
- Goblin Ringleader
- Goblin War Drums
- Goblin Warchief
- Grim Lavamancer
- Hammer of Bogardan
- Incinerate
- Kird Ape
- Lightning Bolt
- Mogg Conscripts
- Mogg Fanatic
- Monastery Swiftspear
- Pillage
- Pyroclasm
- Raging Goblin
- Rorix Bladewing
- Shock
- Siege-Gang Commander
- Skizzik
- Spark Spray
- Spellshock
- Squee, Goblin Nabob
- Starstorm
- Stone Rain
- Sulfuric Vortex
- Thermo-Alchemist
- Two-Headed Dragon
- Viashino Sandstalker
- Young Pyromancer

Green (53)

- Acidic Slime
- Alpha Status
- Ancestral Mask
- Avatar of Might
- Basking Rootwalla
- Beast Within
- Birds of Paradise
- Blastoderm
- Brawn
- Call of the Herd
- Caller of the Claw
- Constant Mists
- Elvish Champion
- Elvish Spirit Guide
- Fecundity
- Fyndhorn Elves
- Genesis
- Giant Growth
- Harrow
- Krosan Tusker
- Lhurgoyf
- Llanowar Elves
- Naturalize
- Nimble Mongoose
- Overgrowth
- Overrun
- Plow Under
- Pouncing Jaguar
- Priest of Titania
- Quirion Ranger
- Rampant Growth
- Rancor
- Ravenous Baloth
- River Boa
- Roar of the Wurm
- Seedborn Muse

- Spike Feeder
- Sylvan Library
- Symbiotic Beast
- Thragtusk
- Uktabi Orangutan
- Verdant Force
- Verduran Enchantress
- Wall of Blossoms
- Wellwisher
- Werebear
- Wild Growth
- Wild Mongrel
- Wirewood Herald
- Wirewood Symbiote
- Worldly Tutor
- Yavimaya Elder
- Young Wolf

Colorless (40)

- Altar of Dementia
- Ashnod's Altar
- Basalt Monolith
- Black Vise
- Bottle Gnomes
- Burnished Hart
- Chief of the Foundry
- Chimeric Idol
- Contagion Clasp
- Darksteel Juggernaut
- Fellwar Stone
- Foundry Inspector
- Gilded Lotus
- Grindstone
- Hedron Archive
- Helm of Awakening
- Helm of Possession
- Howling Mine
- Juggernaut
- Junk Diver
- Karn, Silver Golem
- Lodestone Golem
- Lotus Bloom
- Lotus Petal
- Mazemind Tome
- Mesmeric Orb
- Mind Stone
- Mirrorworks
- Myr Battlesphere
- Nevinyrral's Disk
- Ornithopter
- Solemn Simulacrum
- Steel Overseer
- The Rack
- Thran Dynamo
- Tormod's Crypt
- Triskelion
- Voltaic Key
- Wurmcoil Engine
- Zuran Orb

Multicolored (37)

- Absorb
- Armadillo Cloak
- Baleful Strix
- Bladestitched Skaab
- Blazing Specter
- Bloodtithe Harvester
- Chrome Courier
- Coiling Oracle
- Consume Strength
- Edgewalker
- Fire // Ice
- Fires of Yavimaya
- Firestorm Hellkite
- Fleshtaker
- Gerrard's Verdict
- Goblin Anarchomancer
- Goblin Electromancer
- Goblin Legionnaire
- Goblin Trenches
- Jungle Barrier
- Lightning Helix
- Llanowar Dead
- Mirari's Wake
- Mystic Snake
- Orcish Lumberjack
- Probe
- Prophetic Bolt
- Psychatog
- Putrefy
- Recoil
- Sabertooth Nishoba
- Spiritmonger
- Sterling Grove
- Tempest Drake
- Temporal Spring
- Terminate
- Vindicate

Utility Lands (19)

- Barren Moor
- Cephalid Coliseum
- Darksteel Citadel
- Faerie Conclave
- Forbidding Watchtower
- Forgotten Cave
- Gemstone Mine
- Ghitu Encampment
- Goblin Burrows
- High Market
- Lonely Sandbar
- Mishra's Factory
- Rogue's Passage
- Secluded Steppe
- Spawning Pool
- Stalking Stones
- Tranquil Thicket
- Treetop Village
- Wasteland

Separately-drafted fixing pool (20)

Ten historical "pain lands" (one per ally/enemy color pair) and their corresponding ten guildgates, distributed to drafters via a dedicated secondary land draft rather than mixed into the main packs.

- Adarkar Wastes
- Azorius Guildgate
- Battlefield Forge
- Boros Guildgate
- Brushland
- Caves of Koilos
- Dimir Guildgate
- Golgari Guildgate
- Gruul Guildgate
- Izzet Guildgate
- Karplusan Forest
- Llanowar Wastes
- Orzhov Guildgate
- Rakdos Guildgate
- Selesnya Guildgate
- Shivan Reef
- Simic Guildgate
- Sulfurous Springs
- Underground River
- Yavimaya Coast